

Ariful Islam Anik

anik.mdariful@gmail.com | aianik.github.io | +1 431 588 4594 | Winnipeg, Canada (Open to relocation)

Summary

UX researcher and designer with 7+ years designing and running mixed-methods studies on AI interfaces, producing insights that directly inform design decisions. Deep expertise in how users understand and trust AI systems. Combines research with hands-on prototyping and frontend development to quickly move from insight to artifact.

Experience

Human-Centered AI Researcher, *University of Manitoba, Canada.*

Sept 2018 – Apr 2026

- Designed and led 4 end-to-end user studies with 600+ participants, investigating how presentation style, information depth, and progressive disclosure affect user comprehension of AI interfaces.
- Developed a psychometrically validated dual-format scale measuring AI literacy across multiple dimensions, enabling teams to assess user AI literacy at scale
- Built and iterated on interactive prototypes for each study; used usability testing, semi-structured interviews, and thematic analysis to evaluate designs before and after deployment.
- Translated findings into concrete design recommendations on how AI systems should communicate training data and uncertainty; published at ACM CHI, ACM IUI, and IEEE VL/HCC.
- Communicated research findings to both technical and non-technical stakeholders across institutions; mentored junior researchers on study design and UX methods.

Sessional Instructor, *University of Manitoba, Canada.*

Sept 2024 – Dec 2024

- Taught COMP 3020 (Human-Computer Interaction) to 60 students; guided end-to-end UX projects from needfinding through prototype evaluation.

Assistant Programmer, *Islamic University of Technology, Bangladesh.*

Dec 2016 – Aug 2018

- Built enterprise software systems including a POS platform and internal accounting and procurement tools using Java EE; managed Oracle and MySQL databases across full SDLC.

Software Development Intern, *DataSoft Systems, Bangladesh.*

Nov 2015 – Dec 2015

- Integrated Google Maps API and location services into a mobile HR application to support real-time employee tracking.

Skills

- **Research Methods:** Mixed-methods study design, usability testing, semi-structured interviews, surveys, thematic analysis, statistical analysis (parametric & nonparametric), heuristic evaluation, cognitive walkthroughs, accessibility evaluation.
- **Design:** Figma, prototyping, journey mapping, persona development.
- **Technical:** Python, Javascript, Typescript, React, HTML, CSS, R, SQL.
- **Tools:** Qualtrics, Prolific, Userback, SurveyMonkey, SPSS, GitHub.

Education

- **PhD in Computer Science**, University of Manitoba.

Sept 2020 – May 2026

Thesis: Investigating Impact of Design Factors on Training Dataset Explanations.

- **MSc in Computer Science**, University of Manitoba.

Sept 2018 – Dec 2020

Thesis: Investigating the Feasibility of Explanations that Communicate Training Dataset Information.

- **BSc in Computer Science and Engineering**, Islamic University of Technology.

Dec 2012 – Dec 2016

Publications

Multiple peer-reviewed publications at ACM CHI, ACM IUI, and IEEE VL/HCC on AI explainability, training data transparency, and AI literacy assessment. ([Google Scholar](#))